

18

Pirc Bridge and Lifetime Repertoire System

Transfer useful habits without confusing two different openings



THIS VOLUME

6

deep lessons

12

lesson positions

30

course pages

Connect the Black fianchetto family, cover the main Pirc structures, and build a durable study routine.

LEARN THE STRUCTURE, THEN THE LINE

A four-pass method for a theory-heavy opening

1. DECODE THE POSITION

Read the board before the moves. Name the center, each side's break, the worst piece, the king-safety difference, and the race clock.

2. UNDERSTAND THE CAUSAL CHAIN

Every recommendation connects a cue to a reason and a consequence. If you know only the move, you do not yet know the opening.

3. PLAY THE DECISION

Generate Black's candidates, find White's strongest reply, and choose the resulting structure you understand. The move is the end of the reasoning, not the beginning.

4. RETRIEVE UNDER PRESSURE

Cover the answer key, reconstruct the line, and speak the memory rule. Review after 1, 3, 7, 14, and 30 days, then test the idea in a slow game.

THEORY WARNING

This is a durable concept-first repertoire, not a claim to be a live engine database. Before tournament use, verify sharp forcing branches in Fritz or a current database.

Priority order at the board: legality and tactical survival, king safety, forcing moves, central transformation, activity, structure, then the remembered rule.

SIX LINKED LESSONS

Recognition first, execution second

LESSON 103 | PAGE 4

Decode: Classical Pirc boundary

Same bishop, different center, different opening.

LESSON 104 | PAGE 8

Play: Classical Pirc boundary

Same bishop, different center, different opening.

LESSON 105 | PAGE 12

Decode: The Austrian Attack

In the Pirc, the center often must be hit before it closes.

LESSON 106 | PAGE 16

Play: The Austrian Attack

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LESSON 107 | PAGE 20

Decode: The 150 Attack and study system

Transfer questions and patterns; do not transfer moves blindly.

LESSON 108 | PAGE 24

Play: The 150 Attack and study system

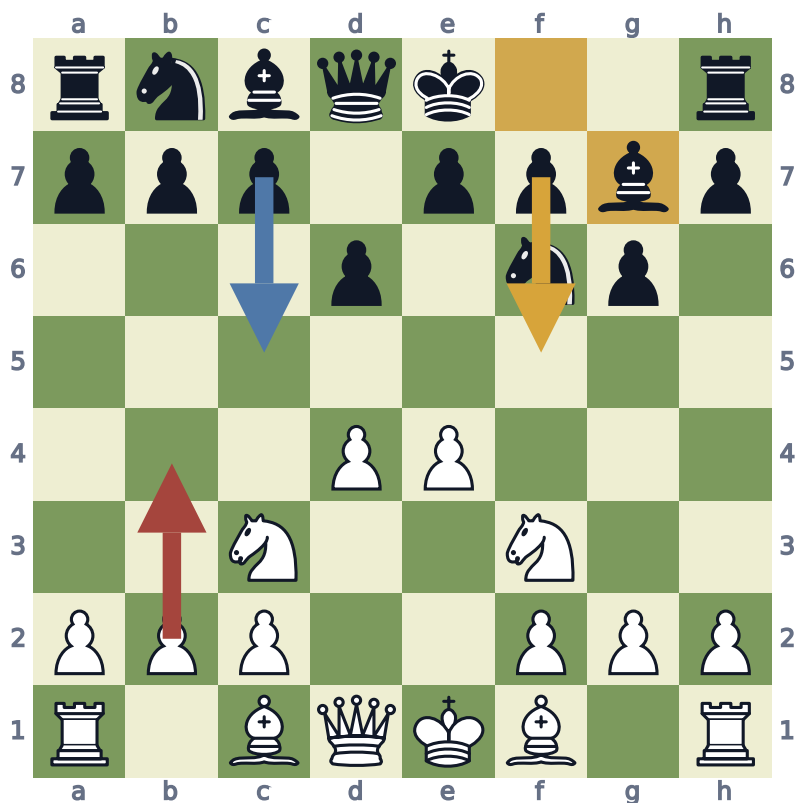
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VOLUME OBJECTIVE

Connect the Black fianchetto family, cover the main Pirc structures, and build a durable study routine.

DECODE PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Decode: Classical Pirc boundary



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

The piece shell resembles the KID, but White's c-pawn is uncommitted and the center can open faster, so Black cannot assume a closed-wing race.

DECISION RULE

Count the central pawns and ask how quickly the e- and d-files can open.

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

Challenge with ...e5 or ...c6 and keep the queen and king ready for direct central tactics.

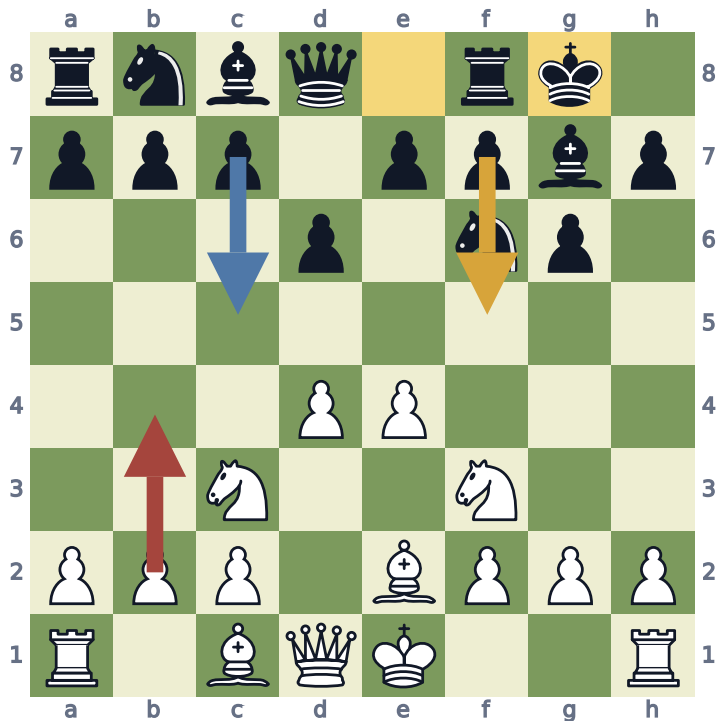
WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White may castle quickly, play Re1, and use e5 or h3.

MEMORY RULE | Same bishop, different center, different opening.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

The piece shell resembles the KID, but White's c-pawn is uncommitted and the center can open faster, so Black cannot assume a closed-wing race.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Challenge with ...e5 or ...c6 and keep the queen and king ready for direct central tactics.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL IDEA

White may castle quickly, play Re1, and use e5 or h3.

FAILURE MODE

Importing automatic ...f5 attacks from the KID can expose Black before development is complete.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Count the central pawns and ask how quickly the e- and d-files can open. Then compare at least two candidates against White's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

RULE | Same bishop, different center, different opening.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 d6 2. d4 Nf6 3. Nc3 g6 4. Nf3 Bg7 5. Be2 O-O



- d4: White changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, open lines, and weakened squares.
- Nf6: Black reroutes a knight toward f6; judge the move by its next square and immediate job.
- Nc3: White reroutes a knight toward c3; judge the move by its next square and immediate job.
- g6: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, open lines, and weakened squares.
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- Bg7: Black changes a bishop's diagonal and the balance between development, pressure, and tempo.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

The piece shell resembles the KID, but White's c-pawn is uncommitted and the center can open faster, so Black cannot assume a closed-wing race.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Count the central pawns and ask how quickly the e- and d-files can open. White's resistance is: White may castle quickly, play Re1, and use e5 or h3. The line fails as a template when: Importing automatic ...f5 attacks from the KID can expose Black before development is complete.

STORE THIS | Same bishop, different center, different opening.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's primary plan, and which piece or pawn enables it?

3. What is White's fastest or most forcing counterplay?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

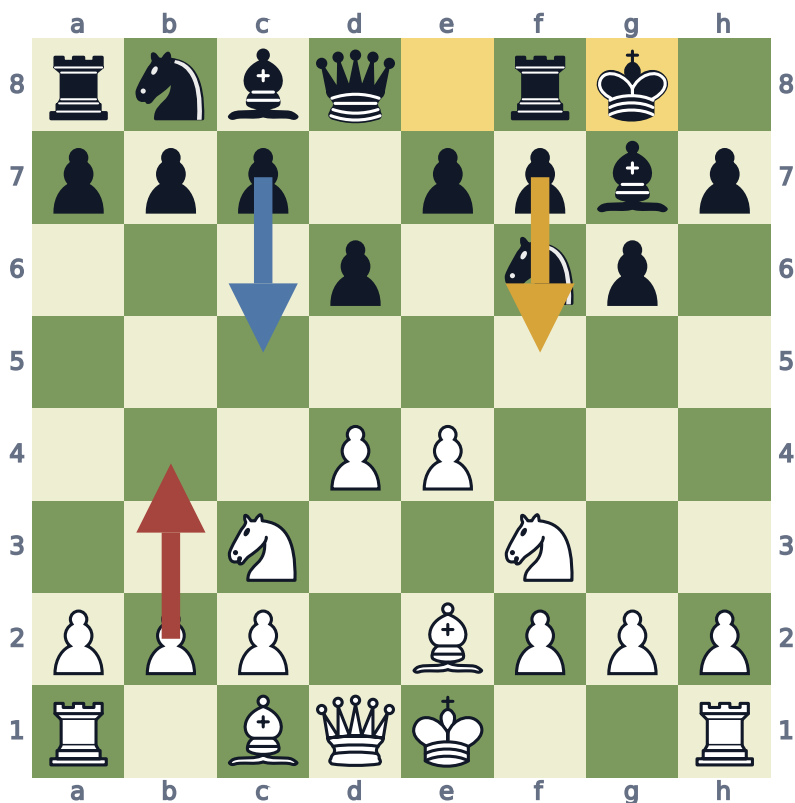
1. The piece shell resembles the KID, but White's c-pawn is uncommitted and the center can open faster, so Black cannot assume a closed-wing race. 2. Challenge with ...e5 or ...c6 and keep the queen and king ready for direct central tactics. 3. White may castle quickly, play Re1, and use e5 or h3. 4. Count the central pawns and ask how quickly the e- and d-files can open. 5. Importing automatic ...f5 attacks from the KID can expose Black before development is complete.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

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PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: Classical Pirc boundary



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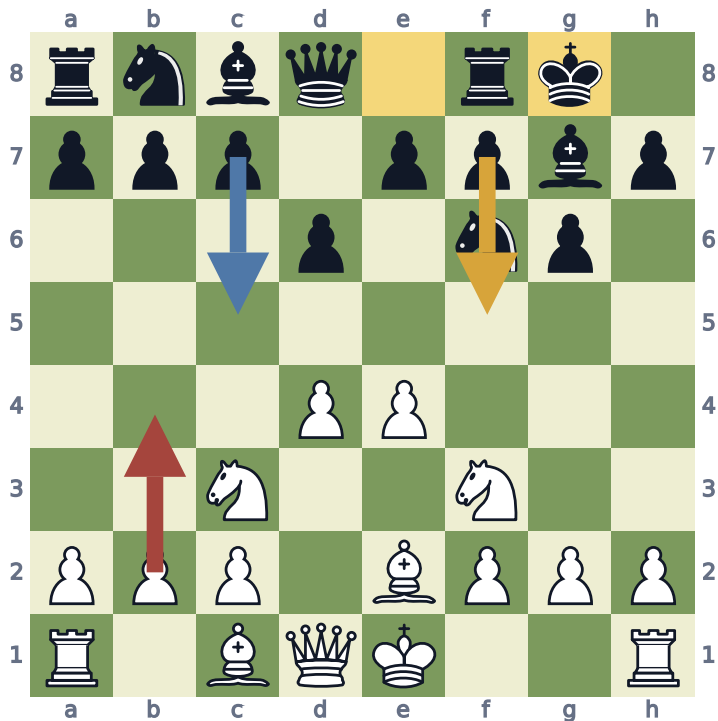
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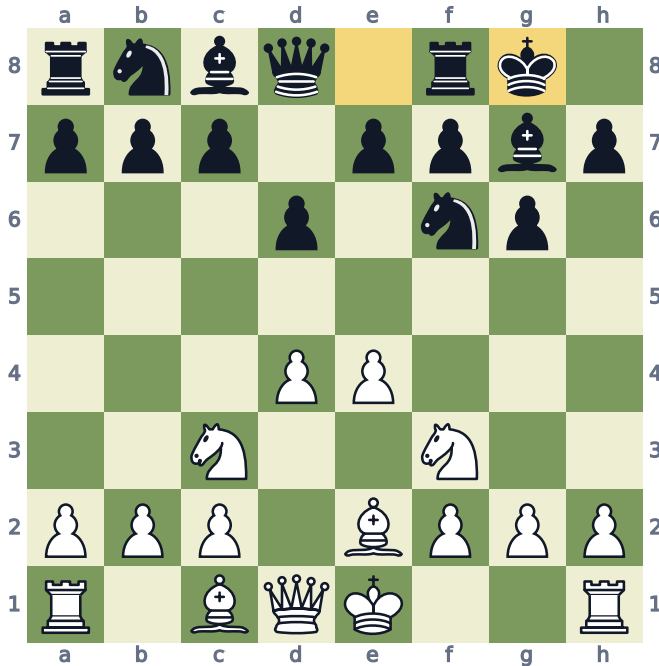
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INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

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- g6: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, open lines, and weakened squares.
- Nf3: White reroutes a knight toward f3; judge the move by its next square and immediate job.
- Bg7: Black changes a bishop's diagonal and the balance between development, pressure, and tempo.
- Be2: White changes a bishop's diagonal and the balance between development, pressure, and tempo.
- O-O: Black secures the king and activates a rook; the central decision can now become concrete.

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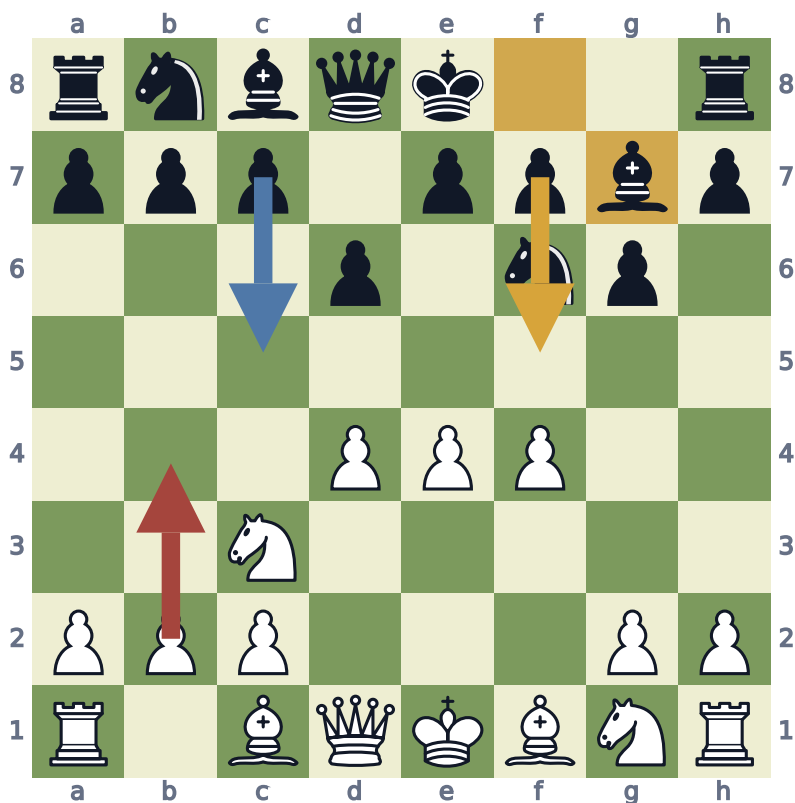
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BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

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DECODE PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Decode: The Austrian Attack

**WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS**

White uses the f-pawn immediately, creating more central force and more dark-square and king-safety responsibility.

DECISION RULE

Treat every central break as a tactical event and verify the king's escape squares.

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

Strike the center with ...c5 or ...e5 and calculate e4-e5 before slow moves.

WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White wants e5, Be3, Qd2, and a direct kingside attack.

MEMORY RULE | In the Pirc, the center often must be hit before it closes.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



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FAILURE MODE

Passive KID-style maneuvering lets White's broad center attack before it becomes a target.

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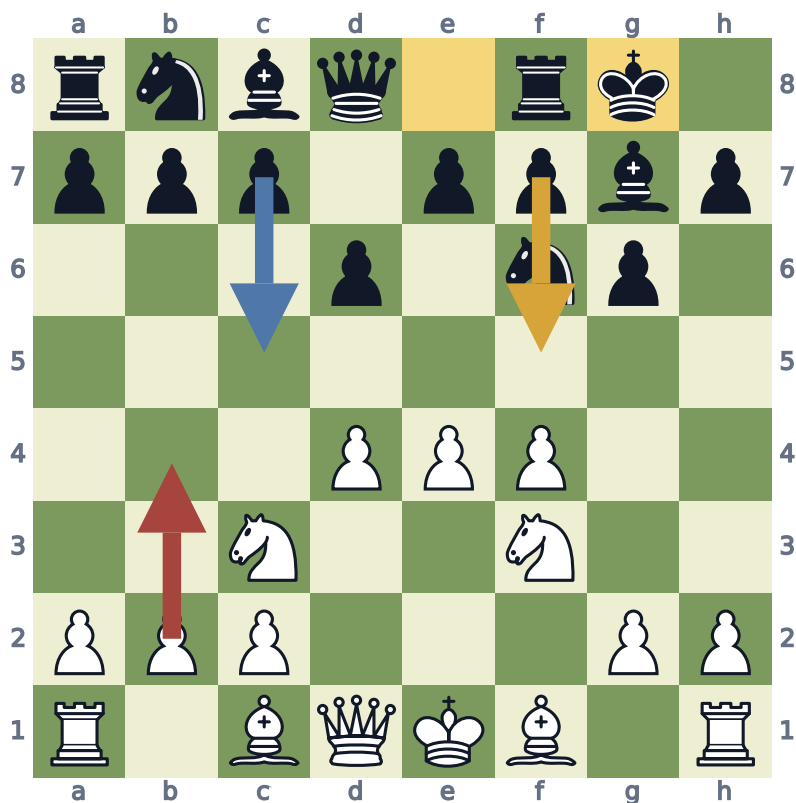
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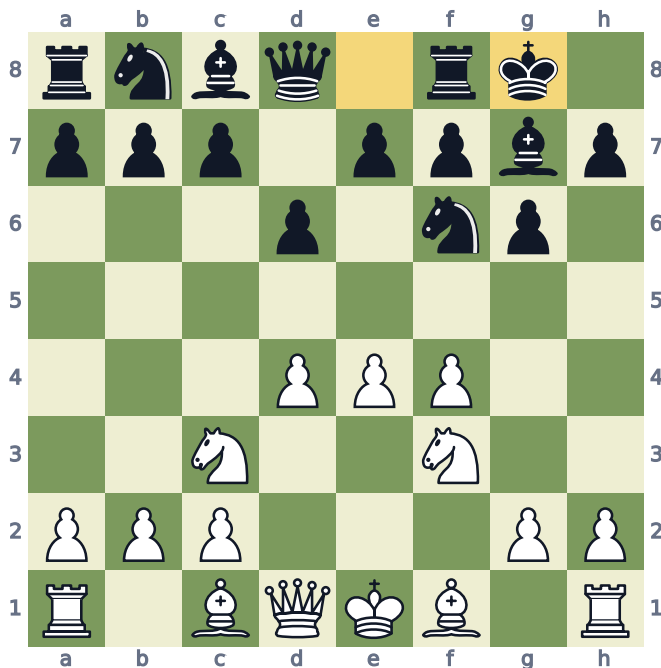
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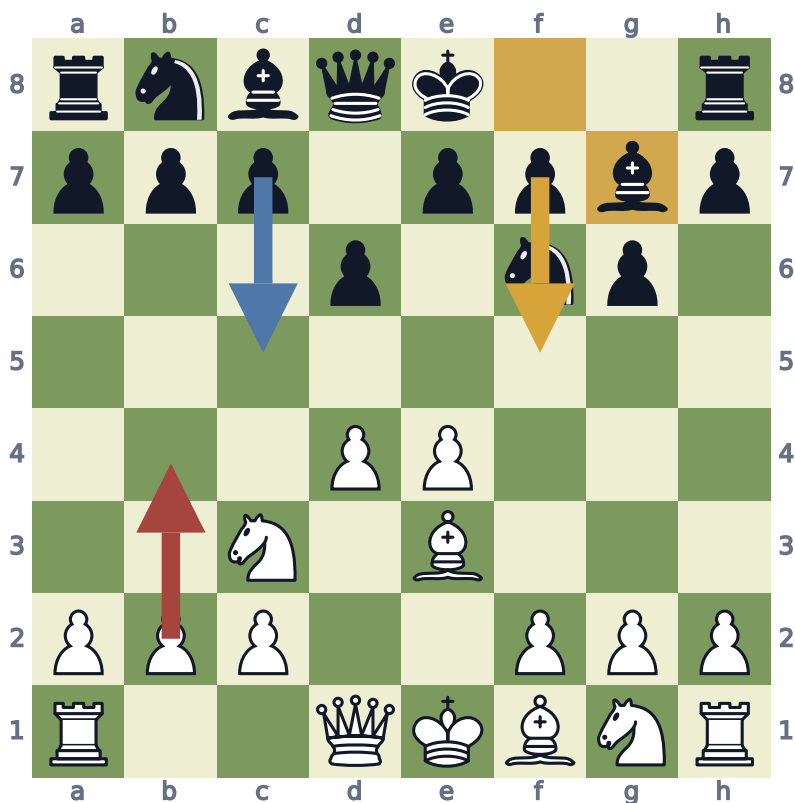
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DECODE PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Decode: The 150 Attack and study system



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

White aims for Bh6, long castling, and h-pawn contact, so Black builds queenside counterplay and a retreat square for the queen.

DECISION RULE

Maintain separate KID and Pirc files, but tag shared patterns such as fianchetto defense, central breaks, and race counting.

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

Use ...b5, ...Nbd7, and central breaks while tracking Bh6 and e5.

WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White seeks a direct opposite-wing attack.

MEMORY RULE | Transfer questions and patterns; do not transfer moves blindly.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



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FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

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Combining the repertoires into one move tree hides the decisive difference made by White's c-pawn.

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INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

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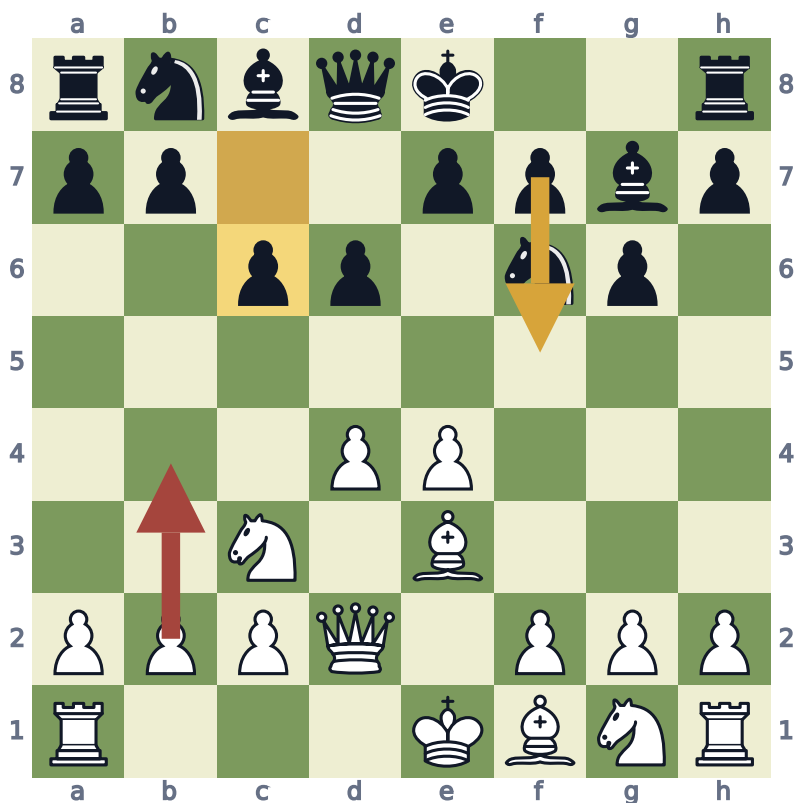
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PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

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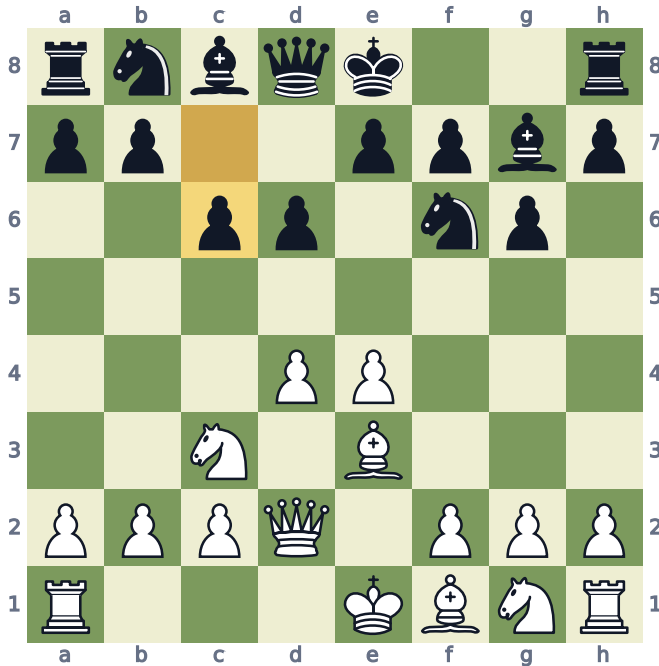
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INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

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- Nc3: White reroutes a knight toward c3; judge the move by its next square and immediate job.
- g6: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, open lines, and weakened squares.
- Be3: White changes a bishop's diagonal and the balance between development, pressure, and tempo.
- Bg7: Black changes a bishop's diagonal and the balance between development, pressure, and tempo.
- Qd2: White coordinates several plans, but the queen's safety and the opponent's forcing reply must be checked.
- c6: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, open lines, and weakened squares.

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SIX-POSITION TEST

Can you retrieve the plan without the chapter?

LESSON 103 Decode: Classical Pirc boundary

Prompt: Count the central pawns and ask how quickly the e- and d-files can open.

Recall: Same bishop, different center, different opening.

LESSON 104 Play: Classical Pirc boundary

Prompt: Count the central pawns and ask how quickly the e- and d-files can open.

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LESSON 105 Decode: The Austrian Attack

Prompt: Treat every central break as a tactical event and verify the king's escape squares.

Recall: In the Pirc, the center often must be hit before it closes.

LESSON 106 Play: The Austrian Attack

Prompt: Treat every central break as a tactical event and verify the king's escape squares.

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LESSON 107 Decode: The 150 Attack and study system

Prompt: Maintain separate KID and Pirc files, but tag shared patterns such as fianchetto defense, central breaks, and race counting.

Recall: Transfer questions and patterns; do not transfer moves blindly.

LESSON 108 Play: The 150 Attack and study system

Prompt: Maintain separate KID and Pirc files, but tag shared patterns such as fianchetto defense, central breaks, and race counting.

PASS STANDARD

For each position: name the structure, Black's plan, White's counterplay, one candidate, the strongest reply, and the failure mode. Score one point each; 30 of 36 is a pass.

THREE SCENARIOS TO STORE

One-page repertoire memory sheet

CARD 1

Classical Pirc boundary

1. e4 d6 2. d4 Nf6 3. Nc3 g6 4. Nf3 Bg7 5. Be2 O-O

Decision: Count the central pawns and ask how quickly the e- and d-files can open.

Memory: Same bishop, different center, different opening.

CARD 2

The Austrian Attack

1. e4 d6 2. d4 Nf6 3. Nc3 g6 4. f4 Bg7 5. Nf3 O-O

Decision: Treat every central break as a tactical event and verify the king's escape squares.

Memory: In the Pirc, the center often must be hit before it closes.

CARD 3

The 150 Attack and study system

1. e4 d6 2. d4 Nf6 3. Nc3 g6 4. Be3 Bg7 5. Qd2 c6

Decision: Maintain separate KID and Pirc files, but tag shared patterns such as fianchetto defense, central breaks, and race counting.

Memory: Transfer questions and patterns; do not transfer moves blindly.

Reconstruct each card from the final position, then from the opening moves alone.

SPACED RETRIEVAL AND GAME TRANSFER

Volume mastery tracker

Lesson	D1	D3	D7	D14	D30	Game	Pass
103 Decode: Classical Pirc boundary	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
104 Play: Classical Pirc boundary	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
105 Decode: The Austrian Attack	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
106 Play: The Austrian Attack	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
107 Decode: The 150 Attack and study system	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
108 Play: The 150 Attack and study system	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

TWELVE-WEEK CYCLE

Weeks 1-2: decode the three structures. Weeks 3-4: replay all lines from memory. Weeks 5-7: solve the workbook pages. Weeks 8-10: test in slow games or against Fritz. Weeks 11-12: analyze failures and retest the volume examination.

PROMOTION RULE

Advance only when you can explain every memory rule, reproduce the three reference lines, name White's best counterplay, and show at least one analyzed game where the decision appeared.

Do not measure mastery by pages completed. Measure whether the correct questions appear during a real game.